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Music from the Carpathian Bow: Silver Lining in Sufferings

The Veretski Pass, a narrow mountain pass in the Carpathians through which the vagrant Jewish people first settled in Transcarpathia¹, witnessed a miserable yet legendary history of the unrelenting struggle of a nation, the Jews, that always armed themselves with optimism and fortitude when facing sufferings.

Yesterday, a band named after this historical path of the Carpathians demonstrated its virtuosic musicianship through the “Old Country” music that originated from the Ottoman Empire, deeply struck a resonance in every listener’s heart—when the performance came to an end, thunderous applause lasted for a long time.

The sweet and agreeable notes from the violin were like the carefree twitters from birds, which drew a picture of several lovely and naughty Jewish kids, playing and laughing, despite the danger of their bitter journey. Along with the exhilarating octaves from the accordion, I sensed a festive optimism that filled the air. However, the low-pitched and grim sound from the bass indistinctly reminded me of what difficult situation that the Jewish ancestors were actually confronted with when they were passing through the broad hills of Carpathians. After the concert, I was completely touched by the tenacity and positive attitude of the Jewish people when they were consistently fighting for a brighter future of their offspring.

The music from the Carpathian Bow tells a story of a group of optimistic and fortitudinous

¹ Veretski Pass. “History”. veretskipass.com. <http://www.veretskipass.com/veretskipass.com/History.html> (accessed October 29, 2019)

people who never gave up to their gloomy fate. I believe as long as the music is still alive, their admirable qualities will always be remembered by future generations.